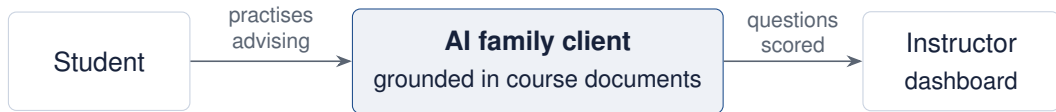

FamilyFinanceChat

Fall 2026: make it solid, give it a face

Professor Mark Fedenia directing the project

FIN 602 Capstone Engineering Team

For a spring class in Wealth Management & Financial Planning



Unlimited practice, at any hour, without booking a human role-player.

- 1 We are **three versions behind** the software we run on.
- 2 The professor's grading tool **runs on a laptop**, not a website.
- 3 Every deployment needs **manual steps** that people forget.

The gap between *a system that works* and *a system you can hand over*.

Never modify Open WebUI's core.

Before

6,500 lines

of their code, forked by us
stuck on one old version



Now

1 line

we just use their release
upgrade any time

The test: *could we take their next release tomorrow, unchanged?*

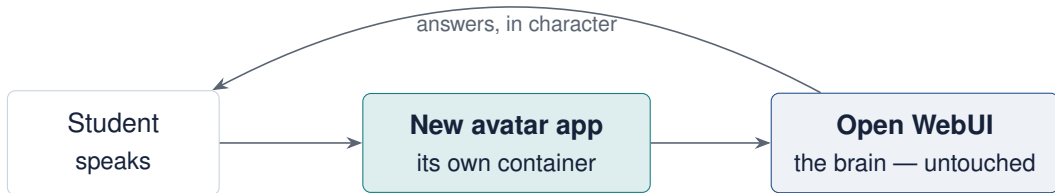
- Upgrade to the **current version** — carefully, one step at a time
- Give the professor a **web address** instead of a laptop
- **Automate** deployment and testing, so upgrades stop breaking things quietly
- **Delete** the last remnants of the old fork

Today the student *types* to the client.

We want them to talk to it.

A face that listens, and answers out loud.

You cannot rehearse a hard question about money
when you have a backspace key.



A **separate app** beside the platform — never inside it.

If it does not work out, we delete one container. Nothing to unpick.

1.2 s

to answer

Slower than that and it stops feeling like a conversation.

\$400

per semester

Roughly, for a class of forty.
Capped, so it cannot run away.

Week 2

consent settled

Voice and video are student records. Agreed before anything is recorded.

29 Sep Students can **talk to it** — voice only, no face yet

20 Oct Pick an avatar provider — **or decide to stop**

27 Oct Platform **upgraded** and running current

17 Nov Five students complete **full spoken sessions**, graded normally

Weekly check-in every Tuesday, 15 September to 1 December.

Voice-only ships in September either way. *The avatar is allowed to fail.*

- A professor grades from **a web address** — no laptop
- Deployments are **automatic**; bad changes never ship
- We know, **with evidence**, whether the avatar helps

The goal is not to finish this system.
It is to leave one where the interesting work is
the teaching, not the plumbing.